

A Treatyse of

Fysshynge wyth an Angle

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Title: A Treatyse of Fysshynge wyth an Angle

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Release date: September 21, 2018 [eBook #57943]

Language: English

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OF FYSSHYNGE WYTH AN ANGLE *****

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A Treatyse of Fysshynge wyth an Angle,
by Dame Juliana Berners

COMPANION VOLUME TO THE "TREATYSE OF FYSSHYNGE WYTH AN
ANGLE."

In the Press, and shortly will be Published, uniform with "The Treatyse of Fysshynge wyth an
Angle,"

A FACSIMILE OF

THE BOOK OF SAINT ALBANS,

BY DAME JULIANA BERNERS.

CONTAINING THE

TREATISES ON HAWKING, HUNTING, AND HERALDRY.

PRINTED AT ST. ALBANS BY THE SCHOOLMASTER-PRINTER IN 1486.

With an Introduction by WILLIAM BLADES, Author of the "Life and Typography of Caxton."

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As THE BOOK OF SAINT ALBANS is the Work in which THE TREATYSE OF FYSSHYNGE WYTH AN ANGLE was incorporated on its first publication, its possession by the Subscribers to the latter should be secured, in order to complete the set of "dyuerse bokys concernynge to gentyll and noble men."

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A Treatyse of Fysshynge wyth an Angle.



A Treatyse of
Fysshyngge wyth an Angle

BY

DAME JULIANA BERNERS:

BEING A *FACSIMILE* REPRODUCTION OF THE FIRST BOOK ON THE

SUBJECT OF FISHING PRINTED IN ENGLAND BY

WYNKYN DE WORDE

AT WESTMINSTER IN 1496.

With an Introduction by

REV. M. G. WATKINS, M.A.



ELLIOT STOCK, 62, PATERNOSTER ROW,
LONDON, E.C.

1880



Preface
to
Dame Juliana Berners'
Treatyse on Fysshynge wyth an Angle.



THE scholarly angler is here presented with an exact *facsimile* of the first English treatise on fishing. The book is of extreme interest for several reasons, not the least curious being that it has served as a literary quarry to so many succeeding writers on fishing, who have not disdained to adapt the authoress's sentiments to their own use, and even to borrow them word for word without acknowledgment. Walton himself was evidently familiar with it, and has clearly taken his "jury of flies" from its "xij flyes wyth whyche ye shall angle to y^e tought & grayllyng;" while Burton, that universal plunderer, has extracted her eloquent eulogy on the secondary pleasures of angling for incorporation with the patchwork structure of his "Anatomy of Melancholy." Besides giving the earliest account of the art of fishing, the estimate which the authoress forms of the moral value of the craft is not only very high, but has served to strike the keynote for all subsequent followers of the art both in their praises and their practice of it. To this little treatise more than to any other belongs the credit of having assigned in popular estimation to the angler his meditative and gentle nature. Many pure and noble intellects have kindled into lasting devotion to angling on reading her eloquent

commendation of it. Such men as Donne, Wotton, and Herbert, Paley, Bell, and Davy, together with many another excellent and simple disposition, have caught enthusiasm from her lofty sentiments, and found that not their bodily health only, but also their morals, were improved by angling. It became a school of virtues, a quiet pastime in which, while looking into their own hearts, they learnt lessons of the highest wisdom, reverence, resignation, and love—love of their fellow-men, of the lower creatures, and of their Creator.

Nothing definite is known of the reputed authoress, Dame Juliana Barnes or Berners. She is said to have been a daughter of Sir James Berners of Roding Berners in the county of Essex, a favourite of King Richard the Second, who was beheaded in 1388 as an evil counsellor to the king and an enemy to the public weal. She was celebrated for her extreme beauty and great learning, and is reported to have held the office of prioress of the Benedictine Nunnery of Sopwell in Hertfordshire, a cell to the Abbey of St. Alban, but of this no documentary evidence exists. The first edition of her “Book of St. Alban’s,” printed by the schoolmaster-printer of St. Alban’s in 1486, treats of hawking, hunting, and coat-armour. In the next edition, “Enprynted at Westmestre by Wynkyn the Worde the yere of thyncarnacōn of our lorde. M.CCCC. lxxxvi,” among the other “treatyfes perteynyng to hawkyng & huntyng with other dyuers playsaunt materes belongyng vnto noblesse,” appeared the present treatise on angling. The aristocratic instincts of the authoress prompted this mode of publication, as she herself explains in the concluding paragraph—“by cause that this present treatyse sholde not come to the hondys of eche ydle persone whyche wolde desire it yf it were enprynted allone by itself & put in a lytyll plaunflet, therefore I haue compyld it in a greter volume of dyuerse bokys concernyng to gentyll & noble men to the entent that the forsayd ydle persones whyche sholde haue but lytyll mesure in the sayd dysporte of fysshing sholde not by this meane vtterly dystroye it.” The present publication is the “little pamphlet” which was enclosed in this “greater volume.” An edition of it as a distinct treatise appears to

have been issued by Wynkyn de Worde soon after that of 1496, with the title, "Here begynnyth a treatyse of fysshynge wyth an Angle" over the curious woodcut of the man fishing which is on the first page of the present *facsimile*, but only one copy of it is known to be in existence. At least ten more editions appeared before the year 1600. This shows the great popularity of the book at the time of its publication, and considering how human nature remains the same, and the charms of angling are equally grateful to every fresh generation of anglers, affords a sufficient reason for the strong antiquarian delight which all literary anglers of the present century have felt in the book. It is worth while briefly to trace the bibliography of angling onwards until the appearance in 1653 of Walton's *Compleat Angler*, when the reader will be on familiar ground. In the interval of more than a hundred and fifty years between these two names of Berners and Walton, so deeply revered by every true scholar of the craft, there occur but four books on angling, though each one of these possesses a fame peculiar to itself. First came Leonard Mascall's *Booke of Fishing with Hooke and Line*, published in 1590. Taverner's *Certaine Experiments concerning Fish and Fruite* followed in 1600. Then came in 1613 the *Secrets of Angling* of the celebrated angling poet, J. D. [John Dennys], whose verses have perhaps never yet been surpassed; and finally, in 1651, appeared Barker's *Art of Angling*. With this fisherman and "ambassador's cook," as he calls himself, Walton must often have conversed.

It is a further testimony to the attractions which angling has always possessed for contemplative natures that the art appears here systematised, so to speak, as early as the middle of the fifteenth century in England, where it has been practised ever since with more enthusiasm and skill than in other countries. There is a sad gap in angling literature from the days of Ausonius, at the commencement of the fourth century, to those of Dame Juliana Berners. Fly-fishing, indeed, is not named between the time of Ælian and that of the *Treatyse*. It is clearly described by the former writer, who alone among the ancients mentions it, but in the present book it is spoken of under the term "angling with a

dubbe,” as if it were well-known and practised. Not only so, but it is clear that the writer had books of angling lore before her, perhaps monkish manuscripts, as Hawkins suggests, which would be of inestimable interest could they now be recovered. Thus in speaking of the carp, the reader will find she writes—“as touchynge his baytes I haue but lytyll knowlege of it. And me were loth to wryte more than I knowe & haue prouyd. But well I wote that the redde worme & the menow ben good baytys for hym at all tymes as I haue herde saye of persones credyble & also founde wryten in bokes of credence.” No better rules can be given for fly-fishing at present than the two which she prescribes for angling—“for the fyrste and pryncypall poynt in anglynge : kepe y^e euer fro the water fro the sighte of the fysshe,” and “also loke that ye shadow not the water as moche as ye may.” The “troughte” is to be angled for “wyth a dubbe” [artificial fly] “in lepynge time;” but as for the salmon, “ye may take hym : but it is seldom seen with a dubbe at suche tyme as whan he lepith in lyke fourme & manere as ye doo take a troughte or a gryalynge.” With the imperfect tackle and clumsy rod of those days, it is no wonder that the capture of salmon with a fly, which is still the crowning achievement of the craft, could seldom be effected.

After the eloquent pleading for angling with which the treatise opens, the lady at once proceeds to teach the making of the “harnays” of it. The rod she orders to be constructed somewhat resembles, save in its larger size, the modern walking-stick rod. A hazel wand, or failing it, one of willow or mountain ash, is to be procured, as thick as the arm and nine feet in length. This is to form the butt, and is to be hollowed out by means of divers red-hot irons into a tapering hole, which is to receive the “croppe,” or top, as we now call it, when not in use. This “croppe” is to be made of a yard of hazel, joined to a length of blackthorn, crab, medlar, or “jenypre.” All these are to be cut between Michaelmas and Candlemas, the lady giving very particular directions as to their drying and the like. When the two portions of the “crop” are “fretted together,” the whole rod is to be shaved into a shapely taper form; the staff

encircled with long hoops of iron or latten at both ends, and finished with a “pyke in the nether ende fastnyd wyth a rennyng vyce : to take in & oute youre croppe.” The line is then to be wound round the crop and tied fast with a bow at the top. The reader will note that there is no mention of a reel; it was only used, seemingly until the beginning of this century, for large salmon and pike. An angler who hooked a fish when armed with this ponderous rod (which must from its description have been nearly eighteen feet long, as large as a modern salmon rod), would act as Izaak Walton would have done in the like predicament,—throw the rod in to the fish and recover it when he could. But the lady is wonderfully pleased with this mighty rod, and thus concludes—“Thus shall ye make you a rodde soo preuy that ye maye walke therwyth : and there shall noo man wyte where abowte ye goo. It woll be lyghte & full nymbyll to fysshe wyth at your luste. And for the more redynesse loo here a fygure,” and she adds the curious woodcut which the reader may see reproduced at page [5](#).

Then follow directions how to dye and make lines and hooks. There were evidently no manufacturers of hooks in the fifteenth century: each angler made his own. The casting of plummets and forming of floats succeed. The six methods of angling and the mode of playing a fish are next treated, and the latter alone shows that Dame Juliana must herself have been a proficient in the craft. No one but a thoroughly good fisher could have summed up the art of playing a fish in the words—“kepe hym euer vnder the rodde, and euermore holde hym streyghte : soo that your lyne may susteyne and beere his lepys and his plungys wyth the helpe of your croppe & of your honde.” The place, the time of day, and the weather in which to fish, are next particularly described after the exactitude peculiar to fishing manuals of the olden time. These paragraphs are well worth the consideration of a modern angler, especially the charge, “yf the wynde be in the Eest, that is worste For comynly neyther wynter nor somer y^e fysshe woll not byte thenne.”

The following part of the treatise, with what baits and how to angle for each kind of fish, together with a brief description of each, certainly

furnished Walton with a model for some of his chapters. This portion of her book is regarded by the authoress as most necessary to be known and proficiency in carrying out her rules “is all the effecte of the crafte.” She adds amusingly, “for ye can not brynge an hoke in to a fyssh mouth wythout a bayte.” A few of the quaint receipts of her age succeed; how to keep live baits, to make pastes and the like, ending with a rule which is often given to flyfishers for trout at the present day: “Whan ye haue take a grete fysshe : vndo the mawe, & what ye fynde therin make that your bayte : for it is beste.”

Just as the authoress rises to eloquence at the beginning of the treatise when comparing the fisher’s happy life with the toils and troubles which too often fall to the lot of the hunter, hawker, and fowler, so the end of these rules once more recalls her enthusiasm. The last two pages of the book give us a portrait of her conception of the perfect angler, and it is no presumption to say that a nobler and truer picture has never been limned. Simplicity of disposition, forbearance to our neighbours’ rights, and consideration for the poor, are strongly inculcated. All covetousness in fishing or employment of its gentle art to increase worldly gain and fill the larder is equally condemned. She holds the highest view of angling; that it is to serve a man for solace, and to cause the health of his body, but especially of his soul. So she would have him pursue his craft alone for the most part, when his mind can rise to high and holy things, and he may serve God devoutly by saying from his heart his customary prayer. Nor should a man ever carry his amusement to excess, and catch too much at one time; this is to destroy his future pleasure and to interfere with that of his neighbours. A good sportsman too, she adds, will busy himself in nourishing the game and destroying all vermin. So will what Walton calls “the civil, well-governed angler” escape the vices which spring from idleness, and enjoy the full delights of an elevating and noble recreation. “And all those that done after this rule shall haue the blessynge of god & saynt Petyr, whyche he theym graunte that wyth his precyous blood vs boughte.”

“And therefore to al you that ben vertuous : gentyll : and free borne I
wryte & make this symple treatyse folowyng : by whyche ye may haue
the full crafte of anglyng to dysport you at your luste : to the entent that
your aege maye the more floure and the more lenger to endure.”

M. G. W.



There begynneth the treatise of fyshynge wyth an Angle.



Alamon in his parables sayth that a good spyryte makyth a flourynge auge / that is a fayre auge & a longe. And syth it is soo : I aske this questyon / . whi | che ben the meanes & the causes that enduce a man in to a mery spyryte. :

Truly to my beste dyscrecōn it semeth good dysportes & honest gamys in whom a man Ioy|eth wythout ony repentannce after. Thenne folowyth it y^t gode dysportes & honest games ben cause of mannys fayr aege & longe life. And therfore now woll I chose of foure good dispor|tes & honeste gamys/that is to wyte: of huntynge: hawkyng: fysshynge: & foullynge. The beste to my symple dyscrecōn why|che is fysshynge: callyd Anglynge wyth a rodde: and a lyne {2} and an hoke/ And therof to treate as my symple wytte may suffyce: both for the sayd reason of Salamon and also for the reason that phisyk makyth in this wyse (¶ Si tibi deficient medici medici tibi fiant: hec tria mens leta labor & moderata dieta.

¶ Ye shall vnderstonde that this is for to saye / Yf a man lacke leche or medycyne he shall make thre thynges his leche & medycyne: and he shall nede neuer no moo. The fyrste of theym is a mery thought. The seconde is labour not outrageous. The thyr|de is dyete mesurable. Fyrste that yf a man wyll euer more be in mery thoughtes and haue a gladde spyryte: he must eschewe all contraryous company & all places of debate where he myghte haue any occasyons of malencoly. And yf he woll haue a labour not outrageous he must thenne ordeyne him to his her|tys ease and pleasaunce wythout studye pensyfnesse or trauey|le a mery occupacyon whyche maye reioyce his herte: & in why|che his spyrytes may haue a mery delyte. And yf he woll be dy|etyd mesurably he must eschewe all places of ryotte whyche is cause of surfette and of syknesse/ And he must drawe him to pla|ces of swete ayre and hungry: And ete nourishable meetes and dyffyable also.

Now thenne woll I dyscryue the sayd dysportes and ga|mys to fynde the beste of theym as veryly as I caⁿ/alle be it that the ryght noble and full worthy prynce the du|ke of Yorke late callid

mayster of game hath discryued the myr|thes of huntynge lyke as I
thynke to dyscryue of it and of alle the other. For huntynge as to myn
entent is to laboryous / For the hunter must alwaye renne & folowe his
houndes : traueyllynge & swetyng full sore. He blowyth tyll his lyppes
blyster And whan he wenyth it be an hare full oft it is an hegge hogge
Thus he chasyth and wote not what. He comyth home at euyn rayn
beten pryckyd : and his clothes torne wete shode all myry Some hounde
lost : some surbat. Suche greues & many other hapyth vnto the hunter /
whyche for dyspleysaunce of theym y^t loue it I dare not reporte. Thus
truly me semyth that this is not the beste dysporte and game of the sayd
foure. The dyspor|te and game of hawkyng is laboryous & noyouse
also as me semyth. For often the fawkeners leseth his hawkes as the {3}
hunter his hōūdes. Thenne is his game & his dysporte goon. Full often
cryeth he & whystelyth tyll that he be ryght euyll a thur|ste. His hawke
taketh a bowe and lysteth not ones on hym rewar|de. whan he wolde
haue her for to flee : thenne woll she bathe.

with mys fedyng she shall haue the Fronse : the Rye : the Cray and
many other syknesses that brynge theym to the Sowse.

Thus by prouff this is not the beste dysporte & game of the sa|yd foure.
The dysporte & game of fowlyng me semyth moost symple For in the
wynter season the fowler spedyth not but in the moost hardest and
coldest weder : whyche is greuous. For whan he wolde goo to his
gynnes he maye not for colde. Many a gynne & many a snare he
makyth. Yet soryly dooth he fare. At morn tyde in the dewe he is weete
shode vnto his taylle. Many other suche I cowde tell : but drede of
magre makith me for to leue. Thus me semyth that huntynge &
hawkyng & also fowlyng ben so laborous and greuous that none of
theym maye perfourme nor bi very meane that enduce a man to a me|ry

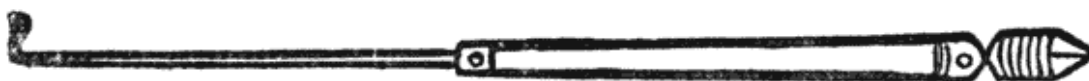
spyryte : whyche is cause of his longe lyfe acordynge vnto y^t sayd
parable of Salamon. ¶ Dowteles the~~re~~ folowyth it that it must nedes be
the dysporte of fysshynge wyth an angle. For all other manere of
fysshynge is also laborous and greuous : often makynge folkes ful wete
& colde / whyche many tymes hath be seen cause of grete Infirmytees.
But the angler maye haue no colde nor no dysease nor angre / but yf he
be causer hymself. For he maye not lese at the moost but a lyne or an
hoke : of whyche he maye haue store plentee of his owne makynge / as
this sym|ple treatyse shall teche hym. Soo thenne his losse is not
greuo|us. and other greyffes maye he not haue / sauynge but yf ony
fisshe breke away after that he is take on the hoke / or elles that he
catche nought : whyche ben not greuous. For yf he faylle of one he
maye not faylle of a nother / yf he dooth as this treatyse techyth : but yf
there be nought in the water. And yet atte the leest he hath his holsom
walke and mery at his ease. a swete ay|re of the swete sauoure of the
meede floures : that makyth hym hungry. He hereth the melodyous
armony of fowles. He seeth the yonge swannes : heerons : duckes : cotes
and many other fou|les wyth theyr brodes. / whyche me semyth better
than alle the {4} noyse of honndys : the blastes of hornys and the scrye
of foulis that hunters : fawkeners & foulers can make. And yf the angler
take fysshe : surely thenne is there noo man merier than he is in his
spyryte. ¶ Also who soo woll vse the game of anglynge : he must ryse
erly. whiche thyng is prouffitable to man in this wy|se / That is to
wyte : moost to the heele of his soule. For it shall cause hym to be holy.
and to the heele of his body / For it shall cause hym to be hole. Also to
the encrease of his goodys. For it shall make hym ryche. As the olde
englysshe prouerbe sayth in this wyse. ¶ who soo woll ryse erly shall be
holy helthy & zely.

¶ Thus haue I prouyd in myn entent that the dysporte & game of anglynge is the very meane & cause that enducith a man in to a mery spyryte: Whyche after the sayde parable of Salomon & the sayd doctryne of phisyk makyth a flourynge aeye & a longe. And therefore to al you that ben vertuous: gentyll: and free borne I wryte & make this symple treatyse folowyng: by whyche ye may haue the full crafte of anglynge to dysport you at your luste: to the entent that your aeye maye the more flou|re and the more lenger to endure.

EF ye woll be crafty in anglynge: ye must fyrste lerne to make your harnays / That is to wyte your rodde: your lynes of dyuers colours. After that ye must know how ye shall angle in what place of the water: how depe: and what ti|me of day. For what manere of fysshe: in what wedyr How ma|ny impedymentes there ben in fysshynge y^t is callyd anglynge And in specyall wyth what baytys to euery dyuers fysshe in e|che moneth of the yere. How ye shall make your baytes brede where ye shall fynde theym: and how ye shall kepe theym. And for the moost crafty thyng how ye shall make youre hokes of stele & of osmonde / Some for the dubbe: and some for the flote: & the grounde. as ye shall here after al thyse fynde expressed o|penly vnto your knowlege.

¶ And how ye shall make your rodde craftly here I shall teche you. Ye shall kytte betwene Myghelmas & Candylmas a fayr staffe of a fadom and an halfe longe: & arme grete of hasyll: wy|lowe: or aspe. And bethe hym in an hote ouyn: & sette hym euyn Thenne lete hym cole & drye a moneth. Take thenne & frette {5} hym faste wyth a cockeshotecorde: and bynde hym to a fourme or an euyn square grete tree. Take thenne a plūmers wire that is euyn and streyte & sharpe at the one ende. And hete the shar|pe end in a charcole fyre tyll it be whyte: and brenne the staffe therwyth thorough: euer streyte in the pythe at

bothe endes tyll they mete. And after that brenne hym in the nether ende wyth a byrde broche / & wyth other broches eche gretter than other. & euer the grettest the laste : so that ye make your hole aye tapre wexe. Thenne lete hym lye styll and kele two dayes. Unfrette hym the^{re} and lete hym drye in an hous roof in the smoke tyll he be through drye ¶ In the same season take a fayr yerde of gre | ne hasyll & beth hym euyn & streyghte. and lete it drye with the staffe. And whan they ben drye make the yerde mete vnto the hole in the staffe : vnto halfe the length of the staffe. And to per | fourme that other halfe of the croppe. Take a fayr shote of blac | ke thor^{gh} : crabbe tree : medeler. or of Ienypre kytte in the same se | ason : and well bethyd & streyghte. And frette theym togyder fe | tely : soo that the croppe maye iustly entre all in to the sayd hole. Thenne shaue your staffe & make hym tapre wexe. Thenne vyrell the staffe at bothe endes wyth longe hopis of yren or la | ton in the clenest wise wyth a pyke in the nether ende fastnyd wyth a rennyng vye : to take in & oute youre croppe. Thenne set your croppe an handfull within the ouer ende of your staffe in suche wise that it be as bigge there as in any other place abo | ue. The^{re} arme your croppe at thouer ende downe to y^e frette wyth a lyne of .vj. heeres. And dubbe the lyne and frette it fast in y^e toppe wyth a bowe to fasten on your lyne. And thus shall ye make you a rodde soo preuy that ye maye walke therwyth : and there shall noo man wyte where abowte ye goo. It woll be lyghte & full nymbyll to fysshe wyth at your luste. And for the more redynesse loo here a fygure therof in example. :



After that ye haue made thus your rodde : ye must lerne to coloure your lynes of here in this wyse. ¶ Fyrste ye must take of a whyte horse taylle the lengest heere and {6} fayrest that ye can fynde. And euer the rounder it be the better it is. Departe it in to .vj. partes : and euery parte ye shall colour by hymselfe in dyuers colours. As yelow : grene : browne : tawney : russet. and duske colours. And for to make a good grene colour on your heer ye shall doo thus. ¶ Take smalle ale a quart and put it in a lytyll panne : and put therto halfe a ponde of alym. And put therto your heer : and lete it boylle softly half an houre. Thenne take out your heer and lete it drye. Thenne take a potell of water and put it in a panne. And put therin two handfull of ooldys or of wyxen. And presse it wyth a tyle stone : and lete it boylle softly half an houre. And whan it is yelow on the scume put therin your heer wyth halfe a ponde of copo | rose betyn in powdre and lete it boylle halfe a myle waye : and thenne sette it downe : and lete it kele fyue or syxe houres. Theñ take out the heer and drye it. And it is thenne the fynest grene that is for the water. And euer the more ye put therto of copo | rose the better it is. or elles in stede of it vertgrees.

¶ A nother wyse ye maye make more brighter grene / as thus Lete woode your heer in an woodefatte a lyght plunket colour And thenne sethe hym in olde or wyxin lyke as I haue sayd : sauynge ye shall not put therto neyther coporose ue vertgrees.

¶ For to make your heer yelow dyght it wyth alym as I haue sayd before. And after that wyth oldys or wyxin wythout copo | rose or vertgrees. ¶ A nother yelow ye shal make thns. Take smalle ale a potell : and stampe thre handfull of walnot leues and put togider : And put in your heer tyll that it be as depe as ye woll haue it. ¶ For to make russet heer. Take stronge lye a pynt and halfe a ponde of sote and

a lytyll iuce of walnot le|uys & a quarte of alym : and put theym alle togyder in a panne and boylle theym well. And whan it is colde put in youre heer tyll it be as derke as ye woll haue it. ¶ For to make a brow|ne colour. Take a pounde of sote and a quarte of ale : and seth it wyth as many walnot leuys as ye maye. And whan they wexe blacke sette it from the fire. And put therin your heer and lete it lye styll tyll it be as browne as ye woll haue it.

¶ For to make a nother browne. Take strong ale and sote and tempre them togyder. and put therin your heer two dayes and two nyghtes and it shall be ryght a good colour. {7}

¶ For to make a tawney coloure. Take lyme and water & put theym togyder : and also put your heer therin foure or fyue hou|res. Thenne take it out and put it in a Tanners ose a day : and it shall be also fyne a tawney colour as nedyth to our purpoos

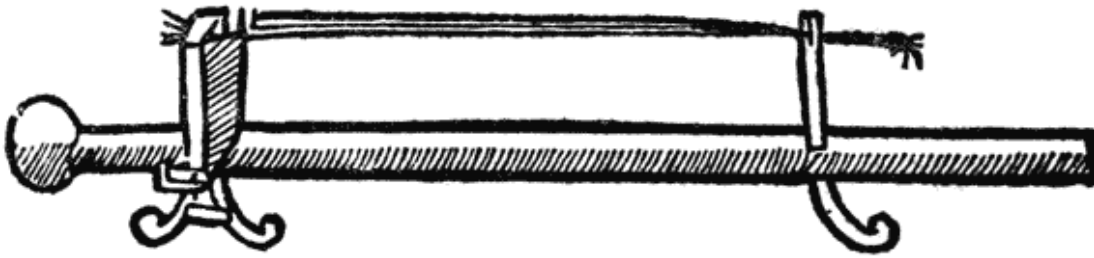
¶ The syxte parte of your heer ye shall kepe styll whyte for ly|nes for the dubbyd hoke to fysshe for the tought and graylyn|ge and for smalle lynes for to rye for the roche and the darse.

 Han your heer is thus colourid : ye must knowe for whi|che waters and for whyche seasons they shall serue.

¶ The grene colour in all clere water from Apryll tyll Septembre. ¶ The yelowe coloure in euery clere water from Septembre tyll Nouembre : For it is lyke y^e wedys and other manere grasse whiche growyth in the waters and ryuers whan they ben broken. ¶ The russet colour seruyth all the wynter vnto the ende of Apryll as well in ryuers as in poles or lakys

¶ The browne colour seruyth for that water that is blacke de|dyshe in ryuers or in other waters. ¶ The tawney colour for those waters that ben hethy or morysshe.

Now must ye make youre lynes in this wyse. Fyrste loke that ye haue an Instrument lyke vnto this fygure portrayed folowyng. Thenne take your heer & kytte of the smalle ende an hondfull large or more / For it is neyther stronge nor yet sure. Thenne torne the toppe to the taylle eue|ryche ylyke moche. And departe it in to thre partyes. Thenne knytte euery part at the one ende by hymself. And at the other ende knytte all thre togyder : and put y^e same ende in that other ende of your Instrument that hath but one clyft. And sett that other ende faste wyth the wegge foure fyngers in alle shorter than your heer. Thenne twyne euery warpe one waye & ylyke moche : and fasten theym in thre clyftes ylyke streyghte. Take thenne out that other ende and twyne it that waye that it woll desyre ynough. Thenne streyne it a lytyll : and knytte it for vn|doynge : and that is good. And for to knowe to make your Instrument : loo here it is in fygure. And it shall be made of tree sauynge the bolte vnderneath : whiche shall be of yren. {8}

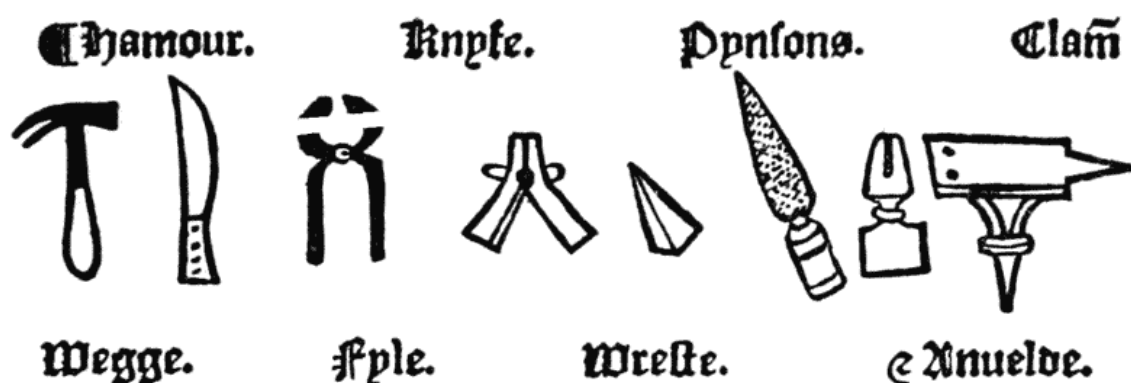


WHan ye haue as many of the lynkys as ye suppose wol suffyse for the length of a lyne : thenne must ye knytte theym togyder wyth a water knotte or elles a duchys knotte. And whan your knotte is knytte : kytte of y^e voyde shor | te endes a strawe brede for the knotte. Thus shal ye make you | re lynes fayr & fyne : and also ryght sure for ony manere fysshe. ¶ And by cause that ye sholde knowe bothe the water knotte & also the duchys knotte : loo theym here in fygure caste vnto the lyknesse of the draughte.

E shall vnderstonde that the moost subtyll & hardyste crafte in makynge of your harnays is for to make your hokis. For whoos makynge ye must haue fetefyles. thyⁿ and sharpe & smalle beten : A semy clām of yren : a bender : a payr of longe & smalle tongys : an harde knyfe somdeale thycke : an anuelde : & a lytyll hamour. ¶ And for smalle fysshe ye shall make your hokes of the smalest quarell nedlys that ye can fyn | de of stele / & in this wyse. ¶ Ye shall put the quarell in a redde charkcole fyre tyll that it be of the same colour that the fyre is. Thenne take hym out and lete hym kele : and ye shal fynde him well alayd for to fyle. Thenne reyse the berde wyth your knyfe / and make the poynt sharpe. Thenne alaye hym agayn : for elles he woll breke in

the bendyng. Thenne bende hym lyke to the bende figuryd hereafter in example. And gretter hokes ye shall mabe in the same wyse of gretter nedles: as broderers nedlis: or taylers: or shomakers nedlis spere poyntes / & {9} of shomakers nalles in especyall the beste for grete fysshe. and that they bende atte the poynt whan they ben assayed / for elles they ben not good ¶ Whan the hoke is bendyd bete the hynder ende abrode: & fyle it smothe for fretynge of thy lyne. Thenne put it in the fyre agayn: and yeue it an easy redde hete. Thenne sodaynly quenche it in water: and it woll be harde and stronge.

And for to haue knowlege of your Instrumentes: lo theym here in fygure portrayd.

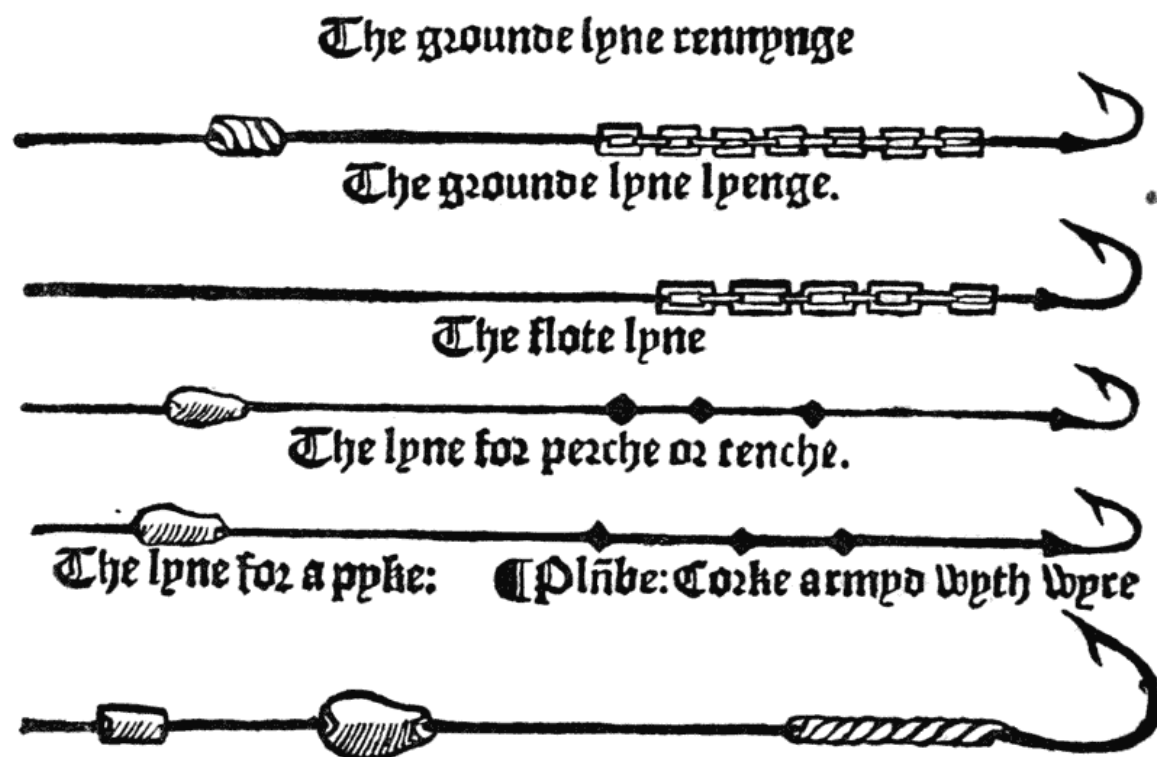


¶ Han ye haue made thus your hokis: thenne must ye set theym on your lynes acordynge in gretnesse & strength in this wyse. ¶ Ye shall take smalle redde silke. & yf it be for a grete hoke theñe double it: not twynynd. And elles for sma|le hokys lete it be syngle: & therwyth frette thycke the lyne the|re as the one ende of your hoke shal sytte a strawe brede. Theñe sette there your hoke: & frette hym wyth the same threde y^e two partes of the lengthe that shall be frette in all. And whan ye co|me to the thyrde parte thenne torne the ende of your lyne aga|yn vpon the frette dowble. & frette it so dowble that other thyr|de parte. Thenne put your threde in at the hose twys or thries & lete it goo

at eche tyme rounde abowte the yerde of your hoke. Thenne wete the hose & and drawe it tyll that it be faste. And lo|ke that your lyne lye euermore wythin your hokys : & not with|out. Thenne kytte of the lynys ende & the threde as nyghe as ye maye : sauynge the frette.

NOw ye knowe wyth how grete hokys ye shall angle to euery fysshe : now I woll tell you wyth how many heeres ye shall to euery manere of fisse. ¶ For the menow wyth a lyne of one heere. For the waxyng roche the bleke & the {10} gogyn & the ruffe wy^t a lyne of two heeris. For the darse & the grete roche wyth a lyne of thre heeres. For the perche : the floū|der & bremet with foure heeres. For the cheuen chubbe : the bre|me : the tenche & the ele wyth .vj. heeres. For the troughte : gray|lynge : barbyll & the grete cheuyn with .ix. heeres. For the grete troughte wyth .xij. heeres : For the samon with .xv. heeres. And for the pyke wyth a chalke lyne made browne with your brow|ne colour aforsayd : armyd with a wyre. as ye shal here hereafter whan I speke of the pyke.

¶ Your lynes must be plumbid wyth lede. And ye shall wyte y^t the nexte plūbe vnto the hoke shall be therfro a large fote & mo|re / And euery plumbe of a quantyte to the gretnes of the lyne. There be thre manere of plūbis for a grounde lyne rennyng. And for the flote set vpon the grounde lyne lyenge .x. plumbes Ioynyng all togider. On the grounde lyne rennyng .ix. or .x. smalle. The flote plūbe shall be so heuy y^t the leest plucke of ony fysshe maye pull it downe in to y^e water. And make your plū|bis rounde & smothe y^t they stycke not on stonys or on wedys. And for the more vnderstandyng lo theym here in figure.



Thenne shall ye make your flotys in this wyse. Take a fayr corke that is clene without many holes. and bore it {11} through wyth a smalle hote yren : And putt therin a penne iuste and streyghte. Euer the more flote the gretter penne & the gre | ter hole. Thenne shape it grete in the myddis and smalle at bo | the endys. and specyally sharpe in the nether ende / and lyke vn | to the fygures folowyng. ¶ And loke that the flote for one heer be nomore than a pese. For two heeres : as a beene. for twel | ue heeres : as a walnot. And soo euery lyne after the proporcōn. ¶ All manere lynes that ben not for the groūde must haue flo | tes. And the rennyng grounde lyne must haue a flote. The ly | enge grounde lyne wythout flote.



Now I haue lernyd you to make all your harnays. Here I woll tell you how ye shall angle. ¶ Ye shall angle : vnderstonde that there is .vi. manere of anglyng. That one is at the grounde for the trougte and other fysshe. A nother is at y^e grounde at an arche / or at a stange where it ebbyth and flowyth : for bleke : roche. and darse. The thyrde is wyth a flote for all manere of fysshe. The fourth wyth a menow for y^e trougte wythout plumbe or flote. The fyfth is rennyng in y^t same wyse for roche and darse wyth one or two heeres & a flye. The syxte is wyth a dubbyd hoke for the trougte & graylyng ¶ And for the fyrste and pryncypall poynt in anglynge : kepe y^e euer fro the water fro the sighte of the fysshe : other ferre on the londe : or ellys behynde a busshe that the fysshe se you not. For yf they doo they wol not byte. ¶ Also loke that ye shadow not the water as moche as ye may. For it is that thyng that woll soone fraye the fysshe. And yf a fysshe be afrayed he woll not bi | te longe after. For alle manere fysshe that fede by the grounde ye shall angle for theim to the botom. soo that your hokys shall renne or lye on the grounde. And for alle other fysshe that fede {12} aboue ye shall angle to theym in the myddes of the water or somdeale byneth or somdeale aboue. For euer the gretter fysshe the nerer he lyeth the botom of the water. And euer the smaller fysshe the more he smymmyth aboue. ¶ The thyrde good poynt is whan the fysshe bytyth that ye be not to hasty to smyte nor to late / For ye must abide tyll ye suppose that the bayte be ferre in the mouth of the fysshe / and thenne abyde noo longer. And this is for the groūde. ¶ And for the flote whan ye se it pul | lyd

softly vnder the water : or elles caryed vpon the water softly : thenne smyte. And loke that ye neuer ouersmyte the strengthe of your lyne for brekyng. ¶ And yf it fortune you to smyte a grete fysshe wyth a smalle harnays : thenne ye must lede hym in the water and labour him there tyll he be drownyd and ouercome. Thenne take hym as well as ye can or maye. and euer bewaar that ye holde not ouer the strengthe of your lyne. And as moche as ye may lete hym not come out of your lynes ende streyghte from you : But kepe hym euer vnder the rodde / and euermore holde hym streyghte : soo that your lyne may sus|teyne and beere his lepyes and his plungys wyth the helpe of your croppe & of your honde.

Here I woll declare vnto you in what place of the water ye shall angle. Ye shall angle in a pole or in a standinge water in euery place where it is ony thyng depe. The|re is not grete choyse of ony places where it is ony thyng de|pe in a pole. For it is but a pryson to fysshe. and they lyue for y^e more parte in hungre lyke prisoners : and therefore it is the lesse maystry to take theym. But in a ryuer ye shall angle in euery place where it is depe and clere by the grounde : as grauell or claye wythout mudde or wedys. And in especyall yf that there be a manere whyrlyng of water or a couert. As an holow ban|ke : or grete rotys of trees : or longe wedes fletyng aboue in the water where the fysshe maye couere and hyde theymsel at certayn tymes whan they lyst Also it is good for to angle in depe styffe stremys and also in fallys of waters and weares : and in floode gatys and mylle pyttes. And it is good for to angle where as the water restyth by the banke : and where the streame rennyth nyghe there by : and is depe and clere by the grounde {13} and in ony other placys where ye may se ony fyssh houe or ha|ne ony fedyng.

Now ye shall wyte what tyme of the daye ye shall angle ¶ From the begynnyng of May vntyll it be Septem | bre the bytyng tyme is erly by the morowe from foure of y^e clocke vnto eyghte of the clocke. And at after none from foure of the clocke vnto eyghte of the clocke : but not soo good as is in the mornynge. And yf it be a colde whystelyng wynde and a derke lowryng daye. For a derke daye is moche better to angle in than a clere daye. ¶ From the begynnyng of Sep | tembre vnto the ende of Apryll spare noo tyme of the daye :

¶ Also many pole fysshes woll byte beste in the none tyde.

¶ And yf ye se ony tyme of the daye the trougt or graylyng lepe : angle to hym wyth a dubbe acordynge to the same month And where the water ebbyth and flowyth the fysshe woll byte in some place at the ebbe : and in some place at the flood. After y^t they haue restynge behynde stangnys and archys of brydgys and other suche manere places.

Here ye shall wyte in what weder ye shall angle. as I sa | yd before in a derke lowryng daye whanne the wynde blowyth softly. And in somer season whan it is brennyng | ge hote thenne it is nought. ¶ From Septembre vnto Apryll in a fayr sonny daye is ryght good to angle. And yf the wynde in that season haue ony parte of the Oryent : the wedyr thenne is nought. And whan it is a grete wynde. And whan it snowith reynnyth or hayllyth. or is a grete tempeste / as thondyr or ligh | tenynge : or a swoly hote weder : thenne it is noughte for to angle.

Now shall ye wyte that there ben twelue manere of ympedymentes whyche cause a man to take noo fysshe. w^t | out other comyn that maye casuelly happe. ¶ The fyrst is yf your harnays be not mete nor fetly made. The seconde is yf your baytes be not good nor fyne. The thyrde is yf that ye angle not in bytyng tyme. The fourth is yf that the fysshe be frayed w^t the syghte of a man. The fyfth yf the water be very

thykke : whyte or redde of ony floode late fallen. The syxte yf the fysshe styre not for colde. The seuenth yf that the wedyr {14} be hote. The eyght yf it rayne. The nynthe yf it hayll or snow falle. The tenth is yf it be a tempeste. The enleuenth is yf it be a grete wynde. The twelfyfth yf the wynde be in the Eest / and that is worste For comynly neyther wynter nor somer y^e fysshe woll not byte thenne. The weste and northe wyndes ben good but the south is beste.

ANd now I haue tolde you how to make your harnays : and how ye shall fysshe therwyth in al poyntes Reason woll that ye knowe wyth what baytes ye shall angle to euery manere of fysshe in euery moneth of the yere / whyche is all the effecte of the crafte. And wythout whyche baytes know | en well by you all your other crafte here toforn auayllyth you not to purpose. For ye can not brynge an hoke in to a fyssh mo | uth wythout a bayte. Whiche baytes for euery manere of fyssh and for euery moneth here folowyth in this wyse.

FOr by cause that the Samon is the moost stately fyssh that ony man maye angle to in fresshe water. Therefore I purpose to begyn^u at hym. ¶ The samon is a gentyll fysshe : but he is comborous for to take. For comynly he is but in depe places of grete ryuers. And for the more parte he holdyth the myddys of it : that a man maye not come at hym. And he is in season from Marche vnto Myghelmas. ¶ In whyche season ye shall angle to hym wyth thyse baytes whan ye maye gete theym. Fyrste wyth a redde worme in the begynnynge & endynge of the season. And also wyth a bobbe that bredyth in a dunghyll. And specyally wyth a souerayn bayte that bredyth on a water docke. ¶ And he bytith not at the grounde : but at y^e flote. Also ye may take hym : but it is seldom seen with a dubbe at suche tyme as whan he lepith in lyke fourme & manere

as ye doo take a troughte or a gryalynge. And thyse baytes ben well prouyd baytes for the samon.

THe Troughte for by cause he is a right deyntous fyssh and also a ryght feruente byter we shall speke nexte of hym. He is in season fro Marche vnto Myghelmas. He is on clene grauely groude & in a streame. Ye may angle to hym {15} all tymes wyth a grounde lyne lyenge or rennyng : sauynge in lepyng tyme. and thenne wyth a dubbe. And erly wyth a rennyng grounde lyne. and forth in the daye wyth a flote lyne.

¶ Ye shall angle to hym in Marche wyth a menew hangyd on your hoke by the nether nesse wythout flote or plumbe : drawynge vp & downe in the streame tyll ye fele hym taste. ¶ In the same tyme angle to hym wyth a groude lyne with a redde wor | me for the moost sure. ¶ In Aprill take the same baytes : & also Inneba other wyse namyd .vij. eyes. Also the canker that bredyth in a grete tree and the redde snayll. ¶ In May take y^e sto | ne flye and the bobbe vnder the cowe torde and the sylke worme : and the bayte that bredyth on a fer^h leyf. ¶ In Iuyn take a redde worme & nyppe of the heed : and put on thyn hoke a codworme byforn. ¶ In Iuyll take the grete redde worme and the codworme togyder. ¶ In August take a flesshe flye & the grete redde worme and the fatte of the bakon : and bynde abowte thy hoke. ¶ In Septembre take the redde worme and the menew. ¶ In Octobre take the same : for they ben specyall for the trougt all tymes of the yere. From Aprill tyll Septembre y^e trough lepyth. thenne angle to hym wyth a dubbyd hoke acordyn | ge to the moneth / whyche dubbyd hokys ye shall fynde in then | de of this treatyse; and the monethys wyth theym :

The grayllynge by a nother name callyd vmbre ia a delycyous
 fysshe to mannys mouthe. And ye maye take hym lyke as ye doo
 the trougt. And thyse ben his bay | tes. ¶ In Marche & in Apryll the
 redde worme. ¶ In May the grene worme : a lytyll breyled worme : the
 docke canker. and the hawthorn worme. ¶ In Iune the bayte that bredyth
 betwene the tree & the barke of an oke. ¶ In Iuyll a bayte that bredyth
 on a fer^h leyf : and the grete redde worme. And nyppe of the he | de :
 and put on your hoke a codworme before. ¶ In August the redde
 worme : and a docke worme. And al the yere after a reddde worme.

The barbyll is a swete fysshe / but it is a quasy meete & a peryllous
 for mannys body. For comynly he yeuyth an introduxion to y^e
 Febres. And yf he be eten rawe : he maye be cause of mannys dethe :
 whyche hath oft be seen Thyse {16} be his baytes. ¶ In Marche & in
 Apryll take fayr fresshe che | se : and laye it on a borde & kytte it in
 small square pecys of the lengthe of your hoke. Take thenne a candyl &
 brenne it on the ende at the poynt of your hoke tyll it be yelow. And
 the^he byn | de it on your hoke with fletchers sylke : and make it rough
 lyke a welbede. This bayte is good all the somer season. ¶ In May &
 Iune take y^e hawthor^h worme & the grete redde worme. and nyppe of
 the heed. And put on your hoke a codworme before. & that is a good
 bayte. In Iuyll take the redde worme for cheyf & the hawthor^h worme
 togyd^r. Also the water docke leyf wor | me & the hornet worme togyder.
 ¶ In August & for all the yere take the talowe of a shepe & softe chese :
 of eche ylyke moche : and a lytyll hony & grynde or stampe theym
 togyd^r longe. and tempre it tyll it be tough. And put therto floure a lytyll
 & make it on smalle pelletys. And y^t is a good bayte to angle wyth at
 the grounde And loke that it synke in the water. or ellys it is not good to
 this purpoos.

THe carpe is a deyntous fysshe : but there ben but fewe in Englonde. And therfore I wryte the lasse of hym. He is an euyll fysshe to take. For he is soo stronge enarmyd in the mouthe that there maye noo weke harnays holde hym. And as touchynge his baytes I haue but lytyll knowlege of it And me were loth to wryte more than I knowe & haue prouyd But well I wote that the redde worme & the menow ben good baytys for hym at all tymes as I haue herde saye of persones credyble & also founde wryten in bokes of credence.

THe cheuyn is a stately fysshe & his heed is a deyty morsell. There is noo fysshe soo strongly enarmyd wyth scalyes on the body. And bi cause he is a stronge byter he hath the more baytes / whiche ben thyse. ¶ In Marche the redde worme at the grounde : For comynly thenne he woll byte there at all tymes of y^e yere yf he be ony thinge hungry. ¶ In Apryll the dyche canker that bredith in the tree. A worme that bredith betwene the rynde & the tree of an oke The redde worme : and the yonge frosshys whan the fete ben kyt of. Also the stone flye the bobbe vnder the cowe torde : the redde snaylle. ¶ In May y^e {17} bayte that bredyth on the osyer leyf & the docke canker togyd^r vpon your hoke. Also a bayte that bredyth on a ferⁿ leyf : y^e cod | worme. and a bayte that bredyth on an hawthorⁿ. And a bayte that bredyth on an oke leyf & a sylke worme & a codworme togyder. ¶ In Iⁿ June take the creket & the dorre & also a red worme : the heed kytte of & a codworme before : and put theym on y^e hoke. Also a bayte in the osyer leyf : yonge frosshys the thre-fete kitte of by the body : & the fourth by the knee. The bayte on the hawthorⁿ & the codworme togyder & a grubbe that bredyth in a dunghyll : and a grete greshop. ¶ In Iuyl the greshop & the humbylbee in the medow. Also yonge bees & yonge hornettes. Also a grete brended flye that bredith in pathes of medowes & the flye that is

amonge pysmeers hyllys. ¶ In August take wortwormes & magotes vnto Myghelmas. ¶ In Septembre the redde worme : & also take the baytes whan ye may gete the | ym : that is to wyte / Cheryes : yonge myce not heeryd : & the hon | ie combe.

THe breeme is a noble fysshe & a deyntous. And ye shall angle for hym from Marche vnto August wyth a redde worme : & the **re** wyth a butter flye & a grene flye. & with a bayte that bredyth amonge grene rede : and a bayte that bre | dyth in the barke of a deed tree. ¶ And for bremettis : take mag | gotes. ¶ And fro that tyme forth all the yere after take the red worme : and in the ryuer browne breede. Moo baytes there ben but they ben not easy & therfore I lete theym passe ouer.

ATenche is a good fyssh : and heelith all manere of other fysshe that ben hurte yf they maye come to hym. He is the most parte of the yere in the mudde. And he styryth moost in Iune & Iuly : and in other seasons but lytyll. He is an euyll byter. his baytes ben thyse. For all the yere browne bree | de tostyde wyth hony in lyknesse of a butteryd loof : and the gre | te redde worme. And as for cheyf take the blacke blood in y^e her | te of a shepe & floure and hony. And tempre theym all togyder somdeale softer than paast : & anoynt therwyth the redde worme : bothe for this fysshe & for other. And they woll byte moche the better therat at all tymes.

¶ The perche is a daynteuous fysshe & passynge holsom and {18} a free bytyng. Thise ben his baytes. In Marche the redde wor | me. In Aprill the bobbe vnder the cowe torde. In May the slo | thor **re** worme & the codworme. In Iune the bayte that bredith in an olde fallen oke & the grete canker. In Iuyll the bayte that bredyth on the osyer leyf & the bobbe that bredeth on the dung | hyll : and the hawthor **re** worme & the codworme. In August the redde worme & maggotes. All the yere after

the red worme as for the beste.

¶ The roche is an easy fysshe to take : And yf he be fatte & pen | nyd thenne is he good meete. & thyse ben his baytes. In Marche the most redy bayte is the red worme. In Apryll the bobbe vnder the cowe torde. In May the bayte y^t bredyth on the oke leyf & the bobbe in the dunghyll. In Iune the bayte that bredith on the osyer & the codworme. In Iuyll hous flyes. & the bayte that bredith on an oke. and the notworme & mathewes & maggotes tyll Myghelmas. And after y^t the fatte of bakon.

¶ The dace is a gentyll fysshe to take. & yf it be well refet the **h** is it good meete. In Marche his bayte is a redde worme. In Apryll the bobbe vnder the cowe torde. In May the docke can | ker & the bayte on y^e slothor **h** and on the oken leyf. In Iune the codworme & the bayte on the osyer and the whyte grubbe in y^e dunghyll. In Iuyll take hous flyes & flyes that brede in pysmer hylles : the codworme & maggotes vnto Mighelmas. And yf the water be clere ye shall take fysshe whan other take none And fro that tyme forth doo as ye do for the roche. For comyn | ly theyr bytynge & theyr baytes ben lyke.

¶ The bleke is but a feble fysshe. yet he is holsom His baytes from Marche to Myghelmas be the same that I haue wryten before. For the roche & darse sauynge all the somer season asmo | che as ye maye angle for hym wyth an house flye : & in wynter season w^t bakon & other bayte made as ye hereafter may know.

¶ The ruf is ryght an holsom fysshe : And ye shall angle to him wyth the same baytes in al seasons of the yere & in the same wi | se as I haue tolde you of the perche : for they ben lyke in fysshe & fedinge / sauynge the ruf is lesse. And therfore he must haue y^e smaller bayte.

¶ The flounder is an holsom fisshe & a free. and a subtyll byter in his

manere : For comynly whan he soukyth his meete he {19} fedyth at grounde. & therefore ye must angle to hym wyth a gro|unde lyne lyenge. And he hath but one manere of bayte. & that is a red worme. whiche is moost cheyf for all manere of fysshe.

¶ The gogen is a good fisshe of the mochenes : & he byteth wel at the grounde. And his baytes for all the yere ben thyse. y^e red worme : codworme : & maggotes. And ye must angle to him w^t a flote. & lete your bayte be nere y^e botom or ellis on y^e gro^unde.

¶ The menow whan he shynith in the water the^u is he byttyr And though his body be lytyll yet he is a rauenous biter & an egre. And ye shall angle to hym wyth the same baytes that ye doo for the gogyn : sauynge they must be smalle.

¶ The ele is a quasy fysshe a rauenour & a deuourer of the bro|de of fysshe. And for the pyke also is a deuourer of fysshe I put them bothe behynde all other to angle. For this ele ye shall fyn|de an hole in the grounde of the water. & it is blewe blackysshe there put in your hoke tyll that it be a fote wythin y^e hole. and your bayte shall be a grete angyll twytch or a menow.

¶ The pyke is a good fysshe : but for he deuouryth so many as well of his owne kynde as of other : I loue hym the lesse. & for to take hym ye shall doo thus. Take a codlynge hoke : & take a roche or a fresshe heering & a wyre wyth an hole in the ende : & put it in at the mouth & out at the taylle downe by the ridge of the fresshe heeryng. And thenne put the lyne of your hoke in af|ter. & drawe the hoke in to the cheke of y^e fresshe heeryng. The^u put a plumbe of lede vpon your lyne a yerde longe from youre hoke & a flote in mydwaye betwene : & caste it in a pytte where the pyke vsyth. And this is the beste & moost surest crafte of ta|kyng the pyke. ¶ A nother manere takynge of him there is. Take a

frosshe & put it on your hoke at the necke bytwene the skynne & body on y^e backe half : & put on a flote a yerde ther | fro : & caste it where the pyke hauntyth and ye shall haue hym. ¶ A nother manere. Take the same bayte & put it in Asa fetida & cast it in the water wyth a corde & a corke : & ye shall not fayll of hym. And yf ye lyst to haue a good sporte : thenne tye the co | rde to a gose fote : & ye shall se god halynge whether the gose or the pyke shall haue the better.

Now ye wote with what baytes & how ye shall angle to euery manere fysshe. Now I woll tell you how ye shall {20} kepe and fede your quycke baytes. Ye shall fede and kepe them all in generall : but euery manere by hymself wyth suche thyng in and on whiche they brede. And as longe as they ben quycke & newe they ben fyne. But whan they ben in a slough or elles deed thenne ben they nought. Oute of thyse ben excepted thre brodes : That is to wyte of hornettys : humbylbees. & waspys. whom ye shall bake in breede & after dyppe theyr heedes in blo | de & lete them drye. Also excepte maggotes : whyche whan thei ben bredde grete wyth theyr naturell fedyng : ye shall fede the | ym ferthermore wyth shepes talow & wyth a cake made of flou | re & hony. thenne woll they be more grete. And whan ye haue clensyd theym wyth sonde in a bagge of blanket kepte hote vn | der your gowne or other war^m thyng two houres or thre. theⁿ ben they beste & redy to angle wyth. And of the frosshe kytte y^e legge by the knee. of the grasshop the leggys & wynges by the body.

¶ Thyse ben baytes made to laste all the yere. Fyrste been flou | re & lene flesshe of the hepis of a cony or of a catte : virgyn wexe & shepys talowe : and braye theym in a mortar : And thenne tem | pre it at the fyre wyth a lytyll purifyed hony : & soo make it vp in lytyll ballys & bayte therwyth your hokys after theyr quan | tyte. & this is a good bayte for all

manere fresshe fysshe.

¶ A nother take the sewet of a shepe & chese in lyke quantyte : & braye them togider longe in a mortere : And take thenne floure & tempre it therwyth. and after that alaye it wyth hony & make ballys therof. and that is for the barbyll in especyall.

¶ A nother for darse. & roche & bleke. take whete & sethe it well & thenne put it in blood all a daye & a nyghte. and it is a good bayte.

¶ For baytes for grete fyssh kepe specyally this rule. Whan ye haue take a grete fysshe : vndo the mawe. & what ye fynde therin make that your bayte : for it is beste.

¶ Thyse ben the .xij. flyes wyth whyche ye shall angle to y^e tro | ught & grayllyng / and dubbe lyke as ye shall now here me tell.

¶ Marche.

THe donne flye the body of the donne woll & the wyngis of the pertryche. A nother doone flye. the body of blacke woll : the wynges of the blackyst drake : and the Iay vnd^r the wyng & vnder the tayle. ¶ Apryll.

¶ The stone flye. the body of blacke wull : & yelow vnder the wyng. and vnder the tayle & the wynges of the drake. In the begynnynge of May a good flye. the body of roddyd wull and lappid abowte wyth blacke sylke : the wynges of the drake & of the redde capons hakyll. ¶ May.

¶ The yelow flye. the body of yelow wull : the wynges of the redde cocke hakyll & of the drake lyttyd yelow. The blacke lou | per. the body of blacke wull & lappyd abowte wyth the herle of y^e pecok tayle : & the wynges of y^e redde capon w^t a blewe heed.

¶ Iune. ¶ The donne cutte : the body of blacke wull & a yelow lyste after eyther syde : the wynges of the bosarde bounde on with barkyd hempe. The maure flye. the body of doske wull the wynges of the blackest mayle of the wylde drake. The tan | dy flye at saynt Wyllyams daye. the body of tandy wull & the wynges contrary eyther ayenst other of the whitest mayle of y^e wylde drake. ¶ Iuyll.

¶ The waspe flye. the body of blacke wull & lappid abowte w^t yelow threde : the wings of the bosarde. The shell flye at saynt Thomas daye. the body of grene wull & lappyd abowte wyth the herle of the pecoks tayle : wynges of the bosarde.

¶ August. ¶ The drake flye. the body of blacke wull & lappyd abowte wyth blacke sylke : wynges of the mayle of the blac | ke drake wyth a blacke heed.

¶ Thyse fygures are put here in ensample of your hokes.

Handwritten musical notation consisting of two rows of notes. The first row contains 10 notes, and the second row contains 7 notes. The notes are stylized, resembling a cursive or shorthand notation.

¶ Here folowyth the order made to all those whiche shall haue the vnderstandynge of this forsayde treatyse & vse it for theyr pleasures.

THAT can angle & take fysshe to your plesures as this forsayd treatyse techyth & shewyth you: I charge & requyre you in the name of alle noble men that ye fysshe not in noo poore mannes seuerall water: as his ponde: stewe: or other necessary thynges to kepe fysshe in wythout his lycence & good wyll. ¶ Nor that ye vse not to breke noo mannys gynnys lyenge in theyr weares & in other places due vnto theym. Ne to take the fysshe awaye that is taken in theym. For after a fysshe is taken in a mannys gynne yf the gynne be layed in the comyn waters: or elles in suche waters as he hireth / it is his owne propre goodes. And yf ye take it awaye ye robbe hym: whyche is a ryght shamfull dede to ony noble man to do y^t that the luyes & brybours done: whyche are punysshed for theyr euyll dedes by the necke & otherwyse whan they maye be aspyed & taken. And also yf ye doo in lyke manere as this treatise shewyth you: ye shal haue no nede to take of other meⁿys: whiles ye shal haue ynough of your owne takyng yf ye lyst to labour therfore. whyche shall be to you a very pleasure to se the fayr bryght shynyng scalyd fysshes dysceyued by your crafty meanes and drawen vpon londe. ¶ Also that ye breke noo mannys heggys in goynge abowte your dysportes: ne opyn noo mannes gates but that ye shytt theym agayn. ¶ Also ye shall not vse this forsayd crafty dysporte for no couetysenes to thencreasyng & sparyng of your money oonly / but pryncypally for your solace & to cause the helthe of your body. and specyally of your soule. For whanne ye purpoos to goo on your dysportes in fysshynge ye woll not desyre gretly many persones wyth you. whiche myghte lette you of your game. And

thenne ye maye serue god deuotly in sayenge affectuously youre custumable prayer. And thus doyng ye shall eschewe & voyde many vices. as ydylnes whyche is pryncypall cause to enduce man to many other vices. as it is ryght well knowen. ¶ Also ye shall not be to raueno | us in takyng of your sayd game as to moche at one tyme : whiche ye maye lyghtly doo yf ye doo in euery poynt as this present treatyse shewyth you in euery poynt. whyche sholde {23} lyghtly be occasyon to dystroye your owne dysportes & other mennys also. As whan ye haue a sufficyent mese ye sholde coueyte nomore as at that tyme. ¶ Also ye shall besye yourselfe to nouryssh the game in all that ye maye : & to dystroye all suche thyn | ges as ben deuourers of it. ¶ And all those that done after this rule shall haue the blessyng of god & saynt Petyr / whyche he theym graunte that wyth his precyous blood vs boughte.

¶ And for by cause that this present treatyse sholde not come to the hondys of eche ydle persone whyche wolde desire it yf it were enpryntyd allone by itself & put in a lytyll plaunflet ther | fore I haue compyled it in a greter volume of dyuerse bokys concernynge to gentyll & noble men to the entent that the for | sayd ydle persones whyche sholde haue but lytyll mesure in the sayd dysporte of fysshynge sholde not by this meane vtterly dys | troye it.

TRANSCRIBER'S NOTE

Original spelling and grammar have been generally retained, with some exceptions noted here. Long s (“ſ”, Unicode character u+017f) have been replaced by “s”. Words that were broken at the end of a line using a word continuation mark, either hyphen or double oblique hyphen (u+2e17), have been rejoined. Supposed words that were broken at the end of a line, but without a word continuation mark, have been rejoined by inserting a vertical line (u+7c) with thin spaces between the two parts of the supposed word. For example, the word “whiche” was often broken after the *i*, and would then be transcribed as “whi | che”. I produced the cover image and hereby assign it to the public domain. In the text edition, italic text is marked with low lines (“_”, u+5f); small capitals text is made uppercase; and superscripted text is marked with “^” (u+5e). Original page images are available from archive.org—search for “treatyseoffysshyy00bern”.

The blackletter pages of the original book had no printed page numbers. Page numbers have been inserted into these ebook editions. If a page number would properly lie within a broken word or a supposed broken word, then the whole word was moved just below the page number.

There were throughout the blackletter part of the printed book instances of a symbol that resembled a y with a smudge over it. These are likely variously e over y or t over y, i.e. abbreviations for *the* and *that*. These symbols have been transcribed according to context as ye or yt. On page [16](#) there was what looks like a “d” with a smudge over it, which has been transcribed as “dr”. Other abbreviations that include a smudged small letter include “wyt”, “wt”, “togydr”, etc. In all these instances, the superscripted mark is a guess based on context.

Paragraphs or sections in the blackletter part were variously marked. Sections were indicated by either *capitulum* or else drop cap. Sparsely supported capitulum (u+2e3f) is replaced by pilcrow (u+b6) in all editions. The text was justified, and sometimes a capitulum would be preceded by white space on the right end of a line of text and a line-break, sometimes by only a single space. Sometimes vertical white space preceded a capitulum or drop cap; sometimes not. There are three instances (see pages [3](#) and [9](#)) of white space on the right end of a line of text followed by a new sentence on a new line, but without either capitulum or drop cap. In these ebook editions, either printed vertical space or a drop cap is transcribed as the beginning of a new paragraph, i.e. as a new `<p>` element in the html edition. Drop caps are indicated in the text edition by “++” preceding the letter.

The colon (u+3a) is used liberally throughout the blackletter part of the book. It was usually printed with no space on either side; less often with a space only on the right side; and rarely with a space only on the left side. Examples of the latter occur at page [4](#) line 4 and at page [8](#) line 2. In this transcription, the colon spacing has been standardized in the blackletter part of the book to narrow space on both sides.

Likewise, the glyph we would call *period* or *full stop* (u+2e) was variously printed with no space on either side, or space on one or both sides. These have been standardized to modern usage: space on right side only. This glyph seems to have been used variously in the ways we

would use full stop or comma. In addition, roman numerals are transcribed with the full stop as in, for instance, “wyth .xij. heeres” (example is from page [10](#)). In many places full stops seem to be missing from the end of a sentence; these have not been corrected.

In the following sentence from page [1](#), “Salamon in his parablys sayth that a good spyryte makyth a flourynge aege / that is a fayre aege & a longe.”, the “/” is our transcription of a glyph shaped somewhat like an abundantly distorted “3”, compressed horizontally. This glyph has been interpreted herein as punctuation, similar to our modern comma or virgule. The glyph was variously printed with no space on either side, or with space on both sides, or with space on the right side. In this ebook, the glyph has been transcribed as solidus (u+2f) with thin space on both sides.

There is one exception. On page [20](#), line 1, the following sentence appears: “Ye shall fede and kepe them all in generall : but euery manere by hymself wyth suche thyng} in and on whiche they brede”. In these html/epub/mobi editions, the mark after *thyng* is shown as an image of the original mark. This mark strongly resembles the glyphs that have been elsewhere transcribed as solidus, but is bolder and more angular. The text edition transcribes this instance as “ ” (u+a76d, Latin small letter IS)

Page [2](#). The following sentence appears: “The seconde is labour not outrageo?” In the text edition, the mark following *outrageo* has been transcribed as “ ” (u+a770, modifier letter US). This character occurs only once in the text.

Page [7](#). The phrase “For is is lyke ye wedys” was changed to “For it is lyke ye wedys”. In the phrase rendered herein as “that it woll desyre ynough”, it has been suggested that the penultimate word should perhaps be “befyxe” instead.

Page [8](#). In “And gretter hokes ye shall mabe in the same wyse”, “mabe” should perhaps be “make”?

Page [10](#). In the illustration caption, “Plūbe : Corke” should perhaps be “Plūbe : Corke”.

Page [12](#). In “the more he smymmyth aboue”, the word should perhaps be “swymmyth”.

Page [13](#). In “in any other placys where ye may se any fyssh houe or ha | ne any fedynge”, “ha | ne” should perhaps be “ha | ue”?

Page [17](#). In the phrase rendered herein “heeryd : & the hon | ie combe.”, “hon | ie” was originally printed as “hou | ie”.

Page [18](#). A smudge after the ampersand was ignored in the phrase “on the osyer & the codworme”.

Page [19](#). In “cast it in the water wyth a corde & a corke”, the illegible mark ahead of “cord” has been transcribed “a ”. Also, the phrase “or ellis on ye groūde” possibly should be “or ellis on ye groūde”.

Page [20](#). In “But whan they ben in a slough”, the original print looked like “ben|in”, with a thick black line between “ben” and “in”. In the phrase “¶ A nother take the sewet”, there

was a smudge after “nother” that might be taken for a comma, removed from this ebook edition. There were no other commas in the blackletter section of the book.

*** END OF THE PROJECT GUTENBERG EBOOK A TREATYSE OF
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